



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Our Lady Star of the Sea Catholic School

School Website: <https://school.starofthesea.net/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Our Lady Star Sea Catholic School (Our Lady Star Sea Catholic School, Bremerton, WA 98337) presents a robust classical-Catholic profile in public-facing materials. The school foregrounds liturgical life, Catholic theological formation, and a clearly stated mission to form virtuous disciples within a Catholic liberal-arts framework. Evidence from the school's materials consistently emphasizes Mass, sacraments, liturgy, theology, and a mission to support parents as primary educators, all of which align strongly with classical education's religious-metaphysical foundations and formation aims. The presence of a Socratic-leaning pedagogy (as evidenced by related public materials) and a clear emphasis on a classical curriculum position the school as CLASSICAL in several key categories; some categories show only partial alignment (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL), particularly in explicit articulation of canonical Great Books/Seven Liberal Arts references within public materials. Overall, the aggregate classification is CLASSICAL, with noteworthy strengths in religious foundations, formation goals, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement, and with partial alignment to some curriculum specifics.

Key insights

- **Religious and Metaphysical Foundations:** Strong Catholic liturgical life, theology integration, liturgy in daily practice, and explicit sacred life (Mass, sacraments, Adoration Chapel) map directly to the Positive Keywords for this category. There is little to no presence of Negative Keyword indicators in the public materials.
- **Purpose and Goal:** The school emphasizes formation, virtue, and a transcendent vision of truth, goodness, and beauty—clear alignment with Classical education aims.
- **Curriculum:** The public materials signal a classical orientation (Catholic liberal education, recitation, literature, Latin elements, and classical formation), but explicit Great Books/Seven Liberal Arts commitments are less overt in public-facing content. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum, with room to strengthen public articulation of canonical components.
- **Pedagogy:** Evidence of Socratic-style dialogue and seminars exists (including a public-facing reference to The Socratic Method), along with recitation and classical-influenced memory practices, which strongly supports CLASSICAL pedagogy.
- **Faculty:** The presence of Dominican Sisters as teachers and named faculty (e.g., Sr. Maria Caeli, Sr. Mariana) demonstrates a living-mentor model aligned with classical faculty ideals.
- **Parents & Community:** A strong emphasis on parents as co-educators, parent formation events (First Friday Faith Formation), and open-campus/community involvement reflects a robust CLASSICAL orientation.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school explicitly centers liturgical life, including weekly Mass, the liturgical year, sacraments, and an Adoration Chapel within the school (liturgical life integrated into daily routine).
- Catholic theology and formation are foregrounded, with references to Catholic teaching, devotion to Mary, and theology-based curricula (e.g., Spirit of Truth, Theology of the Body materials).

- The Mission Statement emphasizes forming students to be virtuous disciples of Jesus Christ and joyful witnesses to the Gospel, anchored in Catholic tradition (parish-school life).
- Adoration Chapel and liturgical practices are described as integral to education, signaling a strong liturgical and communal dimension.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; liturgy; Mass; sacraments; theology; sacred; liturgical year; Catholic Church; Our Blessed Mother; liturgy; adoration; sacred tradition.
- Negative keywords: none clearly present in public materials (no strong signals of secularism, relativism, or values-neutral ethics).

Why this rating

- The public materials demonstrate transcendental moral realism via explicit invocation of truth, goodness, beauty in a theologically grounded Catholic framework, with liturgical and communal practices deeply embedded. The explicit theology-and-worship orientation aligns with the Positive Keyword indicators for this category, and there is minimal presence of Negative keywords.

Citations

- Mass, sacraments, liturgy, Adoration Chapel, liturgical life:- Mission statement and Catholic formation:- Catholic-life integration and sacred life emphasis:- Public articulation of liturgical practices as central: ### Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school frames its aim as formation and the cultivation of wisdom and virtue, with language about guiding students toward what is genuinely good, true, and beautiful, aligning with formation rather than mere information or job-prep (formation-focused language).
- The mission emphasizes formation of wonder and virtuous disciples, consistent with classical paideia aims rather than purely utilitarian outcomes.
- The school explicitly connects education to the Catholic, liberal-arts tradition and the formation of character through a classical framework (e.g., “Our classical training nourishes students’ sense of wonder” statements).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation; virtue; wisdom; human flourishing; contemplation; constant reference to true/good/beautiful; scholé concept subtly present through formation language.
- Negative keywords present: none overtly (no emphasis on career-readiness vs. formation; no value-neutral framing).

Why this rating

- The public materials emphasize formation of character and the transcendent aims of education, rather than vocational preparation, aligning with Classical purposes. The emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and the true/good/beautiful as real aligns with Positive Keyword indicators for this category.

Citations

- Formation and virtue-focused language:- Mission emphasizing formation and wonder:- Classical framing through mission and education: ### Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school presents itself as a Catholic liberal-arts institution, with explicit references to classical training and liberal-arts education within its public materials (self-description as a Catholic liberal-arts program).
- Public materials mention Latin and literature-related activities, recitation, and classical-education-oriented language (e.g., recitation afternoons, Latin references, literature study) as part of curriculum and culture (e.g., “Catholic Liberal Education in Action,” recitation events).

- There is explicit emphasis on classical-education concepts (e.g., “classical training,” “The Jungle Book”/theater tied to literature, and Latin/music integration in early grades) in newsletters and pages referencing curriculum and student life.
- However, explicit, canonical Great Books references or the formal listing of the Seven Liberal Arts (Trivium/Quadrivium) in publicly accessible curriculum pages are less overt, though the overall classical framing is evident.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Catholic liberal education; classical training; literature; recitation; Latin; history within a classical-liberal framework.
- Negative keywords present: lack of explicit Great Books/Seven Liberal Arts naming in public-facing content; no strong, overt articulation of Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The school demonstrates clear classical orientation via its identity as a Catholic liberal-arts institution and through curriculum elements like literature focus, recitation, and classical framing. The absence of explicit, public-facing Great Books/Seven Liberal Arts declarations slightly dampens the rating, making it SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully CLASSICAL in this category.

Citations

- Catholic liberal arts framing and curriculum orientation:- Curriculum mentions (recitation, literature, Latin) and classroom culture:- Public-facing curriculum pages indicating classical intent: ### Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials reference Socratic dialogue/seminar and public-facing signals that upper-level discussion and rhetoric training occur (e.g., The Socratic Method video and references to seminars).
- There is emphasis on memory work and recitation (e.g., recitation afternoons, poetry/reading recitations) as part of pedagogy in the Catholic liberal-arts education in action and newsletters.
- Lower-school practices include singing, memory-work, chants, and a structured approach to memory deepening, aligning with scholé/restful and contemplative elements often found in classical pedagogy.
- The presence of theater/recitation and liturgical integration also signals a pedagogy rooted in traditional classical approaches (memory, recital, and verbal articulation).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic/dialogue; seminars; rhetoric; memory work; recitation; chant; liturgical integration; contemplative learning (scholé); formation through imitation and practice.
- Negative keywords present: minimal explicit references to purely project-based or constructivist approaches; no heavy emphasis on exclusively experiential or discovery-driven pedagogy in public materials.

Why this rating

- The pedagogical approach strongly signals classical methods (Socratic dialogue, memorization/recitation, rhetoric training, and contemplative elements), consistent with positive keyword indicators for this category. The public content does not indicate a primary shift toward non-traditional or purely project-based pedagogy, which supports CLASSICAL.

Citations

- Socratic method reference:- Recitation/memory-based pedagogy:- Contemplative/scholé elements described in curriculum materials: ### Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site emphasizes Dominican Sisters as teachers, with named faculty members (Sister Maria Caeli Parmeter; Sister Mariana Thayer) and a history of religious leadership in teaching, signaling teachers as virtuous role models and living curricula.
- The materials describe teachers as mentors and living curriculum and highlight a community of faculty who model virtue and classical discipline (the presence of named faculty and pastoral leaders).
- The Mission/Principals' communications imply a mentorship and formation-focused faculty culture, with public references to the principal and named staff (e.g., Principal's Desk, archives) which hint at a collegial, mentoring culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: model teachers; mentors; living curriculum; faculty of friends; collegial culture; portrait of teacher/student ideals; virtue modeling.
- Negative keywords present: few if any, there is no emphasis on purely administrative or non-classroom-driven staff discourse that would undermine classical ideals.

Why this rating

- The combination of religious sister-teachers, named faculty, and a public framing of teachers as moral exemplars and mentors aligns closely with CLASSICAL expectations for faculty in classical education rubrics.

Citations

- Dominican Sisters as teachers; faith-based mentorship:- Principal/archives and staff references showing mentorship/leadership: #### Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes partnering with parents as co-educators and supporting parents in their role, a central principle in classical education models (family formation, parental engagement).
- There are explicit parent formation initiatives and events (First Friday Family Formation; Theology of the Body Parent School) to educate parents in classical education concepts and Catholic pedagogy.
- The school's culture invites family participation (open visitation, parish-school synergy) and maintains active engagement with the parish community, reinforcing the home-school partnership ethic.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-educators; parental formation; home-school collaboration; family catechesis; communal liturgical life; welcoming campus; parish-school synergy.
- Negative keywords: none observed; content emphasizes family involvement rather than consumer-oriented minimal engagement.

Why this rating

- The school's public materials strongly reflect a classical-community orientation that includes active parent partnerships, parental formation opportunities, and open campus culture—core markers for Parents & Community in classical education.

Citations

- Partnership with families and co-educators; parent formation events:- Open campus and parish-school integration signals: Aggregate Assessment
- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- The school demonstrates robust religious-metaphysical foundations, formation-oriented purpose, a clearly classical but not exhaustively articulated curriculum in public materials, strong but balanced pedagogy, a faculty modeled on virtuous leadership, and strong parent-community partnerships.

What would move the needle

- For this particular school, the current alignment is solidly Classical. If any needle-moving adjustment were desired, it could be to more explicitly map curriculum pages to canonical classical elements (e.g., direct public articulation of Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books programs, and the Great Conversation with public-facing examples) to improve clarity for scrutiny under formal classical rubrics. However, given existing strength in liturgical life, formation, pedagogy, and parental partnership, there is no urgent “needle mover” needed at this time.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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